

How to Make Money with Google Maps in South Africa

A free, step-by-step guide — adapted from the "\$800 in 4 hours" Google Maps challenge for SiteCraft SA local businesses.

Your offer: **R1,500 setup + R450 / month**

This guide shows you exactly how to find small South African businesses with weak Google listings, pitch them a done-for-you online presence, and close at **R1,500 once-off + R450/month**. Zero startup cost. Works in a single afternoon.

1. Validate the idea (5 minutes, free)

- Go to **trends.google.com**. Search "**Google Business Profile**" and "**small business marketing South Africa**". Confirm steady interest over 5 years.
- Open Google Maps and search a trade in your town (e.g. plumber Polokwane). If dozens of listings look unfinished, the opportunity is real.
- Only target areas where you speak the local language (English / Afrikaans / Zulu / Xhosa).

Rule: only pursue a niche that isn't a "sinking ship."

2. Learn the skill for free (≈42 minutes)

Google runs a **free "Google Business Profile" course on Skillshop** (Google's own training platform). Take it so you can honestly say you're **Google-trained** and know how to claim, verify and optimise profiles. That credibility is what gets owners to trust you.

3. Find prospects on Google Maps

A — Pick your hunting ground

Start with **smaller towns** (less competition for attention): Polokwane, Nelspruit, Kimberley, Bloemfontein, Gqeberha/PE, Rustenburg, George, Upington. Later move to richer segments (dentists, accountants, attorneys, estate agents).

B — Run the searches

On `maps.google.com`, one town at a time:

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"<trade> in <town>" " <trade> near <town>" " <trade> <suburb>, <town>"
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Trade starter list: salon, beauty spa, nail tech, plumber, electrician, painter, pet groomer, car wash, takeaway, coffee shop, mechanic, tutor, photographer, baker, cleaning service.

C — Spot the weak profiles (red flags)

A business is worth contacting if it shows **2 or more** of these:

- Listing says **"Claim this business"** (never claimed)
- **No website** link
- **Few / low reviews** (under ~20, or under 4.0★)
- **Few photos** (under 5) or poor images
- **Missing hours / phone / address**
- **No posts** in the last 3+ months
- **Weak or blank** description / category
- Ranks low when you search the trade + town

Skip polished businesses (100+ reviews, pro photos, active posts) — hard to sell, don't need you yet.

4. Outreach — WhatsApp first (SA default)

SA owners answer WhatsApp far more than unknown calls. Message without saving the number using Click-to-Chat:

<https://wa.me/27XXXXXXXXXX?text=...> (replace leading 0 with 27)

WhatsApp opener:

Hi {Name}, I'm Thabang from SiteCraft SA ■ I was searching for "{trade}s in {town}" on Google Maps and noticed your business doesn't have a claimed Google profile / website yet. That means locals searching for you right now can't easily find you. I help small businesses like yours get found — a done-for-you Google Business Profile + simple website for a once-off R1,500, then R450/month to keep it topped up. Can I send you a free 2-minute look at what your listing could be? No strings.

Follow-up (if no reply in 2 days):

Hi {Name} ■ just following up. Even a basic Google profile gets you showing up when someone nearby searches "{trade} {town}". I'll send the free mini-audit either way — want me to?

Cold-call script (when you have a number & want speed):

Hi, my name is Thabang from SiteCraft SA. I help small {trade} businesses in {town} show up on Google Maps when customers search. I noticed your listing isn't claimed yet — that's free visibility you're missing. I set these up properly for a once-off R1,500 and R450 a month to keep it running. Can I send you a quick free check of your listing?

5. The free mini-audit (your closer)

Before asking for money, send a 1-page screenshot + notes showing:

- Their current listing **as customers see it** (screenshot from Maps).
- What's missing (the red flags from step 3C).
- A mock of the improved profile (claimed, correct info, 8–10 photos, posts, a "Call/Book" button).
- The math: *"X% of {town} searches for {trade} — each one is a missed call today."*

This is the exact "free assessment" prospects ask for. It builds trust and makes R1,500 feel like a steal.

6. Close & price

Setup: R1,500 once-off (claim + optimise profile, build simple site, photos, posts). **Monthly: R450** (keep posts fresh, reply to reviews, add photos, report views/calls).

To hit day-1 cash fast, close **1 setup**. The R450s are your recurring engine. Unblock hesitant owners with a guarantee: *"Pay R1,200 if I don't get you 5 new reviews in 30 days"* or first month free.

Reference result from the challenge: closed $2 \times \$250 + 1 \times \$200 = \$700$ in 4 hours. Your R1,500 setup is the SA equivalent — and you keep the monthly income.

7. Deliver (so they stay & refer)

- Claim & verify their Google Business Profile.
- Fill every field: hours, services, description, correct map pin.
- Upload 8–10 real photos (ask them to send, or use stock + their logo).
- Add posts (offers, hours, "now open").
- Build the simple site (your R1,500 product) and link it.
- Monthly (R450): keep posts fresh, reply to reviews, add photos, report views/calls.

8. Your 4-hour blitz

Time	Task
0:00–0:15	Validate niche + pick town/trade
0:15–1:00	Maps prospecting → lead list of 20+
1:00–1:45	Send 20 WhatsApp openers
1:45–2:30	Send free mini-audits to replies
2:30–3:30	Call warm replies, handle objections, close
3:30–4:00	Invoice setup, schedule delivery, book follow-ups

9. Lead tracker

Date	Business	Trade	Town	Contact	Red flags	Sent?	Replied?	Meeting	Closed?	Value

Target: 20–30 prospects/week → ~3–5 closes → R4,500–R7,500 setup + R1,350–R2,250/mo recurring.

Principles that make this work

- **Over-deliver** → long-term client → easy upsell. *"Selling to an existing client is ~100× easier than acquiring a new one."*
- Win-win: more visibility for them = recurring income for you.
- Validate before you build. Learn free. Start with the easiest segment.
- He missed the target only by running out of time — **speed of follow-up is the whole game.**

SiteCraft SA — done-for-you websites for South African local businesses. R1,500 setup + R450/month · WhatsApp: +27 74 508 6001 · lehauthabang@gmail.com. Guide adapted from the "I Tried Making \$800 in 4 Hours with Google Maps" challenge (AI Founders, 2023).